Rise of Nationalism in Europe

Page 1: The Dream of Worldwide Democratic Republics

1. Frederic Sorrieu's Vision (1848)

A French artist, Frederic Sorrieu, prepared a series of 4 prints visualizing his dream of a world made up of "Democratic and Social Republics".

The Procession: Men & women of all ages and social classes marching, offering homage to the Statue of Liberty.

Symbols:

[Statue of Liberty] - Torch of Enlightenment & Charter of the Rights of Man.

[Shattered Remains] - On earth, remains of Absolutist institutions (monarchies).

Utopian Vision: An ideal vision of society unlikely to actually exist.

[US & Switzerland (Leaders)] → [France, Germany, etc.] → [Distinct Nations (Flags & Costume)]

2. The French Revolution (1789) - The Starting Point

Nationalism came with the French Revolution.
Transferred power from monarchy to French citizens.

- La Patrie & Le Citoyen - Collective Identity.
- New French Flag (tricolour) - Replaced royal standard.
- National Assembly - Estates General elected & renamed.
- Centralized Admin. System - Uniform laws.
- Abolished Custom Duties - Uniform weights & measures.
- French as Common Language - Regional dialects discouraged.

Page 2: Napoleon and the Civil Code

1. **Napoleon's Rule (1799–1815)**
   Napoleon destroyed democracy in France but revolutionized the administrative field to make the system rational and efficient.

2. **The Civil Code of 1804 (Napoleonic Code)**
   Key Features:
   - [Did away with privileges based on birth] –
   - [Established equality before the law] –
   - [Secured the right to property] –

   Impact outside France: In Dutch Republic, Switzerland, Italy, & Germany:
   - ↳ [Abolished feudal system] –
   - ↳ [Freed peasants from serfdom & manorial dues] –
   - ↳ [Guild restrictions removed in towns] –
   - ↳ [Transport & communication systems improved] –

3. **Reaction of the People**
   - **Initially:** French armies welcomed as 'Harbingers of Liberty' (e.g., Brussels, Mainz, Milan).
   - **Later:** Enthusiasm turned to hostility because new administrative arrangements did not go hand-in-hand with political freedom.
   - **Why?** Increased taxation, censorship, & forced conscription into French armies to conquer Europe outweighed administrative advantages. , TAXS,

Key Line (Exam Ready):
The Civil Code of 1804, usually known as the Napoleonic Code, did away with all privileges based on birth, established equality before the law and secured the right to property.

Page 3: The Making of Nationalism in Europe



1. The Political Patchwork

- Mid-18th century Europe had no "nation-states"
- Germany, Italy, and Switzerland were divided into kingdoms/cantons.
- Habsburg Empire: A patchwork of many different regions and peoples (Austrians, Magyars, Slavs, Italians) ruled by one Emperor. They did not share a collective identity; the only tie was loyalty to the Emperor.

2. The Aristocracy vs. The New Middle Class

- Landed Aristocracy: Socially and politically dominant.
- Small in number, owned estates, spoke French (diplomacy), connected by marriage ties.



- Peasantry: The majority of the population.
- The New Middle Class: Emerged due to industrialization (in England first, then France/Germany).



- Composed of industrialists, businessmen, professionals.
- They were educated and believed that no group should have privileges by birth. Idea: National Unity + Liberalism.

3. What did Liberal Nationalism Stand For?



- Political Sphere:
  - Government by consent.
  - End of autocracy and clerical privileges.
  - A constitution and representative government (Parliament).
    Note: It did not necessarily mean universal suffrage (voting rights were often limited to property-owning men).
- Economic Sphere:



  - Freedom of markets.
  - Abolition of state-imposed restrictions on the movement of goods and capital.

Page 4: The Zollverein & Conservatism (1815)

1. Zollverein (1834)



What: A customs union formed at the initiative of Prussia and joined by most German states.

Prussia → Customs Union ← German States

Achievements:

- Abolished tariff barriers.
- Reduced the number of currencies from over 30 to 2.
- Created a network of railways to stimulate economic mobility.

Significance: It bound Germany economically before it was bound politically.



2. A New Conservatism (After Napoleon's Defeat in 1815)

European governments were driven by Conservatism (respect for tradition, monarchy, church, hierarchy).

Napoleon's Modern Army/Bureaucracy → Strengthen Monarchy

3. The Treaty of Vienna (1815)

Host: Duke Metternich (Austrian Chancellor).

Participants:

Britain | Russia | Prussia | Austria → Defeated Napoleon

Objective: To undo the changes of the Napoleonic wars.

Key Decisions:

- Bourbon Dynasty restored to power in France.
- France lost territories annexed under Napoleon.
- A series of states were set up on the boundaries of France to prevent future expansion (e.g., Kingdom of the Netherlands).
- German Confederation of 39 states (set up by Napoleon) was left untouched.



Key Line (Exam Ready):

The main intention of the Congress of Vienna was to restore the monarchies that had been overthrown by Napoleon and create a new conservative order in Europe.

Page 5: The Revolutionaries (Mazzini)

1. The Fear of Repression

After 1815, liberal-nationalists went underground to avoid arrest.

Secret Societies sprang up to train revolutionaries and spread ideas.

Goals: To oppose monarchies established at Vienna & fight for liberty and freedom.

2. Giuseppe Mazzini (The Soul of Italy)



Profile: Born in Genoa (1807), member of the Carbonari.

Belief: "God had intended nations to be the natural units of mankind." Italy could not remain a patchwork; it had to be forged into a single unified republic.

Societies Founded: Young Italy in Marseilles. Young Europe in Berne.

Metternich's Quote on Mazzini: "The most dangerous enemy of our social order."

3. The Age of Revolutions (1830-1848)

July Revolution (France, 1830): Bourbon Kings were overthrown again by liberals. Louis Philippe was installed as a constitutional monarch.

Belgian Revolution: Sparked by the French uprising, Belgium broke away from the United Kingdom of the Netherlands.

Greek War of Independence (1821-1832): Greece had been part of the Ottoman Empire. Nationalists got support from West Europeans & poets/artists (e.g., Lord Byron).

Treaty of Constantinople (1832): Recognized Greece as an independent nation.

Page 6: Romanticism and Hunger

1. The Romantic Imagination



Definition: A cultural movement which sought to develop a particular form of nationalist sentiment.



Rejection of Science: Romantics criticized the glorification of reason & science. They focused on emotions, intuition, & mystical feelings.



Das Volk: German philosopher Johann Gottfried Herder claimed true German culture was to be discovered among the common people (*das volk*) through folk songs, folk poetry, & folk dances.



Language as a Weapon: In Poland, language was used to resist Russian dominance. The clergy used Polish for religious instruction, leading to their arrest. Polish became a symbol of the struggle.

2. Hunger, Hardship, and Popular Revolt (1830s)



Economic Crisis: Enormous increase in population; job seekers > employment; stiff competition from cheap machine-made goods from England. 



1848 (France): Food shortages & unemployment brought the population of Paris out on the roads. Louis Philippe was forced to flee. A Republic was proclaimed (Suffrage to all males above 21; Right to work guaranteed).



Weavers' Revolt (Silesia, 1845): Weavers revolted against contractors who reduced payments. It was a spontaneous uprising against exploitation.

Page 7: 1848 - The Revolution of the Liberals

1. The Frankfurt Parliament



Context: Parallel to the revolts of the poor, the educated middle classes (Liberals) in Germany revolted.

Event: On 18 May 1848, 831 elected representatives marched to the Church of St. Paul in Frankfurt.



Draft Constitution: They drafted a constitution for a German Nation to be headed by a monarchy subject to a parliament.



The Failure: When they offered the crown to Friedrich Wilhelm IV (King of Prussia), he rejected it & joined other monarchs to oppose the assembly.



The parliament was dominated by the middle classes who resisted the demands of workers/artisans & lost their support. Troops were called in, & the assembly was disbanded.



2. The Issue of Women



Women had formed their own political associations, founded newspapers, & taken part in demonstrations. Yet, they were denied suffrage rights during the election of the Assembly. They were admitted only as observers in the visitors' gallery.

Key Line (Exam Ready):

Though the conservative forces were able to suppress liberal movements in 1848, they could not restore the old order. Monarchs began to introduce changes like abolishing serfdom (e.g., in Russia & Habsburg dominions).

Page 8: The Making of Germany (Unification)

1. Can the Army be the Architect of a Nation?



After 1848, nationalism in Europe moved away from democracy & revolution. It was used by conservatives to promote state power.



Prussia took on the leadership of the movement for national unification.

2. The Architect: Otto von Bismarck

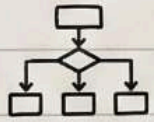


The Chief Minister of Prussia.
He carried out the process with the help of the Prussian Army & Bureaucracy.



Policy: "Blood and Iron" (emphasizes military might).

3. The Process



Three Wars over Seven Years:
War with Denmark → War with Austria → War with France (Franco-Prussian War)



Result: Prussian victory in all three wars completed the process of unification.



4. Proclamation (1871)



In January 1871, the Prussian King, William I, was proclaimed German Emperor in a ceremony held at Versailles (Hall of Mirrors).



The new state placed a strong emphasis on modernizing the currency, banking, legal, & judicial systems in Germany.



Page 9: Italy & Britain (Unification Stories)

1. Italy Unified



Italy was divided into 7 states. Only Sardinia-Piedmont was ruled by an Italian princely house.



The North: Unified by Count Cavour (Chief Minister of Sardinia-Piedmont). He was neither a revolutionary nor a democrat but a brilliant diplomat who engineered a tactful alliance with France to defeat Austria.



The South: Unified by Giuseppe Garibaldi. He led the "Red Shirts" (armed volunteers) & marched into South Italy/Kingdom of Two Sicilies, winning the support of peasants to drive out the Spanish rulers.



The King: In 1861, Victor Emmanuel II was proclaimed king of united Italy.

2. The Strange Case of Britain



No sudden upheaval or revolution. It was a long drawn-out process.

Ethnic Groups: English, Welsh, Scot, Irish.



English Parliament: Seized power from the monarchy in 1688 (Glorious Revolution).



Act of Union (1707): Between England & Scotland. Resulted in the formation of the "United Kingdom of Great Britain". Scotland's culture was suppressed (Gaelic forbidden).



Ireland: Deeply divided between Catholics & Protestants. The English helped Protestants dominate. After a failed revolt by Wolfe Tone (1798), Ireland was forcibly incorporated into the UK in 1801.



British Nation: A new "British nation" was forged through symbols: Union Jack, God Save the King, English language.

Page 10: Visualizing the Nation & The Balkans

1. Visualizing the Nation (Allegory)

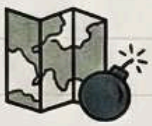


Artists personified the nation as a female figure.
Marianne (France): Red cap, tricolour, cockade
Idea: People's Nation. Statues erected in public squares.



Germania (Germany): Wears a crown of oak leaves (German oak stands for heroism).
Often shown holding a sword (readiness to fight).

2. Nationalism and Imperialism (The Balkans)



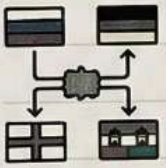
By the last quarter of the 19th century, nationalism lost its liberal-democratic sentiment & became narrow/intolerant.



The Balkans: A region of geographical & ethnic variation (modern-day Romania, Bulgaria, Albania, Greece, etc.).
Inhabitants were called Slavs.



The Powder Keg: Much of the Balkans was under the Ottoman Empire, which was collapsing. Different Slavic nationalities struggled to define their identity & independence.



Big Power Rivalry: Russia, Germany, England, & Austro-Hungary fought for influence over the Balkans (trade, colonies).



Result: This intense rivalry led to a series of wars in the region and finally the First World War in 1914.

Key Line (Exam Ready):
Nationalism, aligned with imperialism, led Europe to disaster in 1914. But the idea that societies should be organized into "nation-states" came to be accepted as natural and universal.